

Skills

Obtaining Blood Pressure by the Two-Step Method

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient's privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Checked patient's baseline reading, determined best site for use.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to patient and family.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers, compared identifiers with information on patient's ID bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained procedure to patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Positioned patient and patient's arm appropriately.	☐	☐	☐	
Exposed upper arm fully, did not place BP cuff over clothing.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured blood pressure cuff was the appropriate size.	☐	☐	☐	
Palpated patient's brachial artery in the antecubital space.	☐	☐	☐	
Positioned BP cuff properly above artery, wrapped fully deflated cuff properly around upper arm.	☐	☐	☐	

Positioned manometer properly, stood no more than 1 yard away from it. ☐ ☐ ☐

Asked patient not to speak while BP is being measured. ☐ ☐ ☐

Palpated or auscultated brachial artery distal to cuff while inflating cuff with other hand. ☐ ☐ ☐

Noted point at which pulse disappeared, inflated cuff appropriately past that point, slowly deflated cuff. ☐ ☐ ☐

Noted point at which pulse reappeared. ☐ ☐ ☐

Fully deflated cuff, waited 30 seconds. ☐ ☐ ☐

Cleaned earpieces, diaphragm, and bell of stethoscope with alcohol swabs. ☐ ☐ ☐

Placed earpieces in ears, ensured sounds were clear and not muffled. ☐ ☐ ☐

Located the brachial or radial artery as appropriate and placed either the bell or the diaphragm of the stethoscope over it, did not let chest piece touch cuff or patient's clothing. ☐ ☐ ☐

Closed valve on pressure bulb properly, quick inflated cuff to the proper pressure. ☐ ☐ ☐

Released valve on pressure bulb, let manometer fall properly, observed point at which the first clear sound was heard. ☐ ☐ ☐

Continued to deflate cuff slowly, noted pressure at which sound disappears. ☐ ☐ ☐

Listened after last sound, let remaining air escape quickly, discussed findings with patient, removed cuff. ☐ ☐ ☐

Took patient's BP again after 2 minutes, used second set of measurements as baseline. ☐ ☐ ☐

Repeated process on other arm when necessary. ☐ ☐ ☐

Helped patient into a comfortable position, covered upper arm, discussed findings with patient, reported any abnormal values to practitioner. ☐ ☐ ☐

Performed hand hygiene. ☐ ☐ ☐

Cleaned BP cuff per manufacturer’s instructions and the organization’s practice, cleaned earpieces and diaphragm of stethoscope, if applicable, per the organization’s practice.

☐☐☐

Compared findings with the appropriate classification of blood pressure.

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Compared BP measurement to patient’s baseline.

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Helped patient into a comfortable position, placed personal items within reach.

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Placed call light within easy reach, ensured patient knew how to use it.

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Raised side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient’s safety.

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Disposed of used supplies and equipment, left patient’s room tidy.

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Removed and disposed of gloves when worn, performed hand hygiene.

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Documented and reported patient’s response and outcomes.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____